



BEAR MICROCOMPUTER SYSTEMS

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77-68 Usergroup Newsletter No. 1

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Introduction

Already there has been active support for this group and a few hardware tips have arrived with promises of more, such as a design for a Cmos hex keyboard. Information concerning racking systems is held and should assist the user in his choice of card frame.

Tips

1. Rumour has it that suitable 77 way double sided edge connectors at £1.50. may be available from:-

Keytronics
332 Ley Street,
Ilford. 01-553-1863

2. The colour burst crystal used in TVs has a frequency of 4.43MHz and costs £1.90. plus 35p p & p from:-

P.H.D. Components,
Centenary Estate,
Jefferies Road,
Enfield, Middlesex.

Errors in the circuit Diagram

page 37 of the Manual - figure 9.

X19,7402 o/p signal is

SWSEL

X22,X23 enable signal is

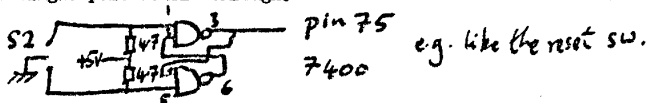
SWSEL

X22,11 should be X22, 4

X6, 10, 11 should be X6, 11, 12

X6, 11, 12, (between BA & run lamp) should be X6, 6, 5.

A hardware 'funny' came to light. If the halt switch, S2, is not debounced the 6800 can get confused! The fix is an external 7400 mounted on the switch which has to be single pole double through.



R 30 is now redundant.

Sorry about that. Murphy's Law again.

Hardware Library

D.1. Debugging Information

If when you have completed your board less memory & 6800 & your LED's don't work, follow this procedure to locate the fault. 6 pages A.4.

D.2. Detailed parts list of suitable VERO rack

D.3. Detailed parts list of Critchley rack

D.4. p.c.b. track Layout.

(The cheapest & most satisfactory racking system has yet to emerge. If anybody locates one that is significantly better than VERO please contact the user group).

77-68 parts

The "Bear" has reduced the IC prices for 77-68 on 1st September, and now carries stocks of all the components. The turn round time is usually 24 hours and in emergencies late night 'phone calls have resulted in instant despatches! Send an s.a.e. for the latest price list if you still need any parts.

Proposed 77-68 extentions

1. Casette Interface board

A Kansas City cassette recorder interface with enough ROM & RAM to load a region of protected memory with any monitoring system you fancy. This will enable you to store your programs permanently!

2. A V24/RS232C Interface board

This will allow members lucky enough to have Teletypewriter or V.D.U. to work directly with the CPU board without having to touch the toggle switches. It will use the Mikbug® monitoring ROM and have 1K or 2K of memory available.

3 Memory Board

This board will use 4K dynamic RAM's fully buffered and will be as full as possible e.g. 8K minimum.

Information will be released in two stages

- a) Proven circuit diagrams
- b) Documentation p.c.b.'s

If your needs are urgent send a small self-addressed envelope with the board No. marked on the front, and as soon as the info. is available you will be notified.

Please be patient as at least 2 months will pass before anything appears and the specs may well be changed.

If you can contribute alternative designs or other extentions please contact the User group.

To use the Hardware Library send an A4 s.a.e. & 18p in stamps. All items loan only.

Best wishes to all users.

Tim Moore

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